

JAINISM — CONTINUOUS AT-A-GLANCE MASTER FLOW

what Jainism is -> the real -> six substances -> the soul -> knowledge -> standpoints -> seven predications -> four indices -> evaluation -> bondage -> eight karmas -> the path and the fourteen stages -> synthesis

Read the numbered rail downward. Stage 00 fixes what the system is for, stages 01 to 03 build the ontology, stages 04 to 07 derive the logic from it, stage 08 evaluates the result, stages 09 to 11 carry bondage and liberation, and stage 12 supplies the comparison, the PYQ rail and the answer spine. The final subordinate node is optional enrichment only.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW Jaina master flow · complete core spine before optional enrichment · prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA · prior artefacts unchanged · exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00

WHAT JAINISM IS: THE QUESTION THAT ORGANISES THE SYSTEM

JINA = CONQUEROR OF PASSIONS

TIRTHANKARA = FORD-MAKER, NOT CREATOR

TATTVĀRTHASŪTRA — BOTH TRADITIONS

NĀSTIKA ON THE VEDA CRITERION ONLY

ANĪŚVARAVĀDA ABOUT CREATION

THREE JEWELS = THE PATH FORMULA

THE GOVERNING QUESTION

Why does a soul that is intrinsically omniscient behave like an ignorant one?

Answer: something real is covering it, and the covering is subtle matter.

Every later doctrine — ontology, logic, ethics — services that one answer.

TEXTUAL ANCHOR AND NAMES

Tattvārthasūtra of Umāsvāti (Śvetāmbara) / Umāsvāmi (Digambara).

Rare cross-sectarian authority; shared text is not doctrinal uniformity.

Kundakunda (Samayasāra); Siddhasena Divākara and Samantabhadra; Akalañka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, Yaśovijaya.

CLASSIFICATION AND ITS TRAP

Unorthodox because it rejects Vedic authority — the primary criterion.

Rebirth, action-consequence and liberation are all affirmed, unlike Cārvāka.

Trap: nāstika does not mean atheist; Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet Veda-accepting.

Twenty-four ford-makers; Mahāvira is the twenty-fourth and a renewer, never the founder.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Substances are eternal and modes explain production, so a creator does no explanatory work and religious authority becomes achieved rather than creative.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism is a pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage.

01

STAGE 01

THE DEFINITION OF THE REAL: PERMANENCE THROUGH CHANGE

SAT = UTPĀDA + VYAYA + DHRAUVYA

MANY-SIDEDNESS (ANEKĀNTAVĀDA)

THE THREE TERMS ARE JOINT

DRAVYA PERSISTS

GUṆA ABIDES

PARYĀYA CHANGES

SADASATKĀRYAVĀDA

GOLD BRACELET: the starting mode of one enduring substance

VYAYA — the bracelet-mode genuinely ends

UTPĀDA — the ring-mode genuinely begins

DHRAUVYA — the gold persists through both

RESULT: permanent as substance, changing as mode

WHY NEITHER EXTREME WORKS

Pure permanence cannot explain that the bracelet actually became a ring.

Pure flux cannot explain why this is recognised as the same gold.

So the real must be defined by all three terms together, not by one.

THE THREE-LEVEL ANALYSIS

Substance (dravya) — the enduring bearer: what changed?

Quality (guṇa) — the abiding characteristic: what kind of thing is it?

Mode (paryāya) — the changing state: what is it doing now?

Consciousness is a guṇa of the soul; delusion and omniscience are paryāyas.

CAUSATION FOLLOWS AT ONCE

Effect continuous with the cause as substance, novel as mode.

Between Sāṃkhya satkāryavāda and Nyāya asatkāryavāda.

Trap: calling Jaina causation satkāryavāda drops the respect-index that defines it.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Many-sidedness is generated here, because a real constituted by innumerable aspects cannot be exhausted by any single unqualified proposition.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The real originates, decays and persists at once, so permanence belongs to it as substance and change belongs to it as mode.

02

STAGE 02

THE SIX SUBSTANCES AND THE EXTENSION TEST

SIX SUBSTANCES

FIVE EXTENDED SUBSTANCES

TIME IS AN-ASTIKĀYA

ONLY MATTER HAS FORM

SOUND IS A MATERIAL MODIFICATION

MEDIA, NOT MERIT AND SIN

SUBSTANCE	EXPLANATORY TASK	EXTENDED (ASTIKĀYA)?	HAS FORM (RŪPA)?
Soul (jīva)	Why is there an experiencer at all?	Yes — has space-points, co-extensive with the body	No
Matter (puṅgava)	Why is there body, sense-object and karmic accretion?	Yes — extended and aggregative	YES — the only one
Medium of motion (dharma)	Why is movement possible? An enabling condition, not a push	Yes — co-extensive with world-space	No
Medium of rest (adharma)	Why is rest possible? An enabling condition, not a brake	Yes — co-extensive with world-space	No
Space (ākāśa)	Where does everything fit?	Yes — world-space and beyond-world space	No
Time (kāla)	Why is there a before and an after?	NO — a substance but not an astikāya	No

THE SAFE FORMULA

Six substances, five extended substances (pañcāstikāya), plus time.

Writing six astikāyas converts a precise doctrine into an avoidable error.

CONTESTED AND CROSS-SCHOOL POINTS

Digambara accounts characteristically affirm time-atoms; some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of time as disputed.

Sound is a modification of matter, not a quality of ether as in Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika.

Atoms (paramāṇu) combine into aggregates (skandha); elemental kinds belong to developed modes.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each substance is admitted for a distinct explanatory task, so removing any member would leave a real gap rather than merely shortening a list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina pluralism is an explanatory scheme rather than a list, since consciousness, corporeality, motion, rest, accommodation and succession each demand a distinct real.

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medium or rest (adnarma)	why is rest possible? An enabling condition, not a brake	yes — co-extensive with world-space	NO
Space (ākāśa)	Where does everything fit?	Yes — world-space and beyond-world space	No
Time (kāla)	Why is there a before and an after?	NO — a substance but not an astikāya	No

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03

STAGE 03

THE SOUL: INNUMERABLE, LUMINOUS, EMBODIED

INNUMERABLE AND DISTINCT SOULS

ANANTA-CATUṢṬAYA

UPAYOGA IS INTRINSIC

PRADEŚA AND THE LAMP SIMILE

STHĀVARA AND TRASA

NYĀYA ATTACKS THE EXTENSION

SOUL (jīva): conscious substance, beginningless, never merged into any absolute

LIBERATED (mukta-jīva) — free of every karmic obstruction

BOUND (baddha-jīva) — embodied, karmically conditioned, capacities veiled

IMMOBILE (sthāvara) one-sense beings and MOBILE (trasa) two- to five-sense beings

WHAT THE SOUL ALREADY HAS

- Infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power — present as capacity.
- Bondage is obscuration, not annihilation; liberation is removal, not addition.
- Trap: intrinsic omniscience is never empirical omniscience of the bound soul.

SPATIALITY AND ITS COST

- The soul has space-points and is co-extensive with its body.
- Lamp simile: the lamp fills the room it occupies without becoming the room.
- Nyāya objects that an eternal self should not literally expand and contract.
- Reply: extension is a mode of embodied individuality, not gross magnitude.

WHY THIS GROUNDS THE ETHICS

- Earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied beings are one-sense knowers.
- Injury therefore falls on a conscious substance, not on a thing.
- Non-violence is a consequence of the ontology, not an excess of feeling.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because the soul is intrinsically luminous and contingently covered, the entire path can be stated as the removal of a real covering rather than the acquisition of a new perfection.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Souls are innumerable and intrinsically luminous, so bondage covers precisely what liberation uncovers.

04

STAGE 04

KNOWLEDGE: THE INVERSION AND THE LADDER OF UNVEILING

DIRECTNESS = NO MIDDLEMAN

SĀMṂVYAVAHĀRIKA PRATYAKṢA

KṢĀYOPAŚAMIKA COGNITION

FIVE KINDS OF KNOWING

KUMATI, KUŚRUTA, VIBHAṅGA

SMṚTI AND PRATYABHIJÑĀ ADMITTED

MATI — sense-and-mind cognition: INDIRECT

ŚRUTA — verbal and scriptural, derived from mati: INDIRECT

AVADHI — limited clairvoyance: DIRECT but bounded

MANAḤPARYĀYA — others' mental modes: DIRECT, not total

KEVALA — unmediated omniscience: DIRECT and COMPLETE

THE INVERSION THAT IS EXAMINED

- Seeing a pot depends on organ, mind and karmic veiling.
- So ordinary perception is conventionally direct only, and strictly mediated.
- Do not map Jaina pratyakṣa onto Nyāya pratyakṣa; the word carries different weight.

ERROR IS ORIENTATION-RELATIVE

- Under wrong vision, mati becomes kumati and śruta becomes kuśruta.
- Perverted clairvoyance is vibhaṅga-jñāna.
- Accurate content held for pride or contempt still functions as wrong cognition.

LATER JAINA LOGIC ADMITS

- Recollection (smṛti), recognition (pratyabhijñā), pervasion-grasping reasoning (tarka).
- Inference (anumāna) and testimony (śabda) as indirect knowledge.
- Contrast: Nyāya denies memory the status of an independent means of knowledge.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because knowledge-obscuring karma is only partly removed in ordinary knowers, finite cognition grasps aspects rather than wholes, so unconditioned assertion belongs to omniscience alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Conditional predication follows necessarily from a theory of knowledge in which ordinary cognition is karmically partial.

05

STAGE 05

STANDPOINT THEORY: THE NARROWING FUNNEL OF SEVEN STANDPOINTS (NAYA)

NAIGAMA · SAMGRAHA · VYAVAHĀRA

RJUSŪTRA IS THE HINGE

ŚABDA · SAMABHIRŪḬHA · EVAMBHŪTA

NAYĀBHĀSA = ABSOLUTISED VIEW

NIŚCAYA AND VYAVAHĀRA NAYA

NOT THE SEVEN PREDICATIONS

A STANDPOINT IS AN UNFINISHED TRUTH, NOT AN ERROR

SUBSTANCE-DIRECTED: naigama (practical), samgraha (generic), vyavahāra (particular)

THE HINGE: rjusūtra restricts attention to the present state

MODE-DIRECTED AND VERBAL: śabda (expression), samabhirūḍha (etymology), evambhūta (function in act)

HOW A STANDPOINT IS PERVERTED

- Standpoint plus denial of the remaining aspects equals nayābhāsa.
- That is the technical form of one-sidedness (ekāntavāda).
- It converts Jaina criticism of rivals from complaint into diagnosis.

EACH RIVAL DIAGNOSED

- Momentariness absolutises the present-state view, so identity becomes fiction.
- Permanence-monism absolutises the substance-directed view, so change becomes appearance.
- Extreme nominalism absolutises the verbal views, so the object dissolves into usage.

KUNDAKUNDA'S PAIR

- Real standpoint: the soul in its own intrinsic nature.
- Conventional standpoint: the soul as embodied, active and karmically conditioned.
- Not Advaita's two levels — both describe one real soul, and nothing is sublated.

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MECHANISM / VERDICT —

The list moves from loosest and practical to strictest and function-conditioned, so it classifies the routes by which a true aspect hardens into an exclusive claim.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A standpoint becomes error only when it forgets its own conditions, which is exactly what the sevenfold classification is designed to prevent.

06

STAGE 06

SEVENFOLD PREDICATION: WHY EXACTLY SEVEN FORMS

SYĀT = IN A CERTAIN RESPECT

NEVER 'PERHAPS'

3 SINGLY + 3 PAIRWISE + 1 JOINT

FOURTH IS SYĀD AVAKTAVYAM

NOT A THIRD TRUTH-VALUE

SVARŪPA AFFIRMS, PARARŪPA DENIES

THREE PRIMITIVES: affirmation (asti), negation (nāsti), inexpressibility (avaktavya)

→

TAKEN SINGLY: syād asti · syān nāsti · syād avaktavyam = 3 forms

→

TAKEN IN PAIRS: asti+nāsti · asti+avaktavya · nāsti+avaktavya = 3 forms

→

TAKEN JOINTLY: asti+nāsti+avaktavya = 1 form

→

TOTAL = SEVEN. Not arbitrary, and not extendable

THE SEVEN, IN ORDER

- 1 syād asti — in some respect, it is. 2 syān nāsti — in some respect, it is not.
- 3 syād asti ca nāsti ca — successively, it is and is not.
- 4 syād avaktavyam — in some respect, it is inexpressible.
- 5, 6 and 7 combine inexpressibility with affirmation, with negation, and with both.

WHAT THE OPERATOR DOES

- It states the respect and does not weaken the assertion.
- The jar conditionally exists is not a guess that the jar probably exists.
- Reflexively, conditional predication is itself asserted syāt.

WHAT INEXPRESSIBILITY IS NOT

- Not mystical silence: the same jar is expressible under each separate index.
- Not suspension of judgement: every form is a definite assertion.
- Not a truth-value gap: it marks the failure of one unqualified simultaneous utterance.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Three primitives taken singly, in pairs and jointly generate exactly three plus three plus one forms, which is why the number seven is derived rather than stipulated.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The particle syāt is an index rather than a hedge, so the seven forms record conditions of truth rather than degrees of doubt.

07

STAGE 07

THE FOUR INDICES THAT BLOCK THE CONTRADICTION CHARGE

DRAVYA · KṢETRA · KĀLA · BHĀVA

SAME RESPECT IS NEVER ASSERTED

ŚAMKARA'S CHARGE ANSWERED HERE

OWN-FORM VERSUS OTHER-FORM

NO SUBLATION, UNLIKE ADVAITA

INDEX	WHAT IT FIXES	THE JAR IS	THE JAR IS NOT
Substance (dravya)	The material or kind under which the claim holds	clay	gold
Place (kṣetra)	The location relative to which it holds	on this table	in that room
Time (kāla)	The temporal reference of the claim	now	yesterday
Mode (bhāva)	The state or form under which it holds	jar-shaped	lump-shaped

THE FORMAL REPLY

- Contradiction requires the same respect, the same time and the same sense.
- Existence is asserted in own-form; non-existence is asserted in other-form.
- Without naming the four indices the reply is assertion rather than argument.

WHAT SURVIVES THE REPLY

- Śamkara: a doctrine that qualifies even itself may lose assertoric force.
- Rāmānuja: opposed real attributes in one substance remain unintelligible.
- Jaina counter: the opposition holds between aspects of substance and mode.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Because opposed predications differ in substance, place, time or mode, the schema never affirms and denies in the same respect, so the classical charge misdescribes the doctrine before evaluating it.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Contradiction is avoided by difference of respect, not by weakening either the affirmation or the denial.

08

STAGE 08

EVALUATING NON-ABSOLUTISM: THREE DISTINCT CHALLENGES

SELF-REFUTATION OR TRIVIALITY

2022: RELATIVISM NEEDS ABSOLUTISM

2025: PLURALIST AND REALIST?

KEVALA-JŪĀNA IS THE PIVOT

QUALIFIED REALISM

RESIDUE MUST BE STATED

A — SELF-REFUTATION OR TRIVIALITY

- If qualified it looks weak; if unqualified it breaks its own rule.
- Jaina reply walks through the first horn: the thesis is itself asserted svāt.

B — THE 2022 ABSOLUTISM CHARGE

- The charge equivocates between denying exclusivism and denying comprehensiveness.
- Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.

C — THE 2025 CLASSIFICATION

- Plural: six substances, innumerable souls, many perfected souls, no monistic reduction.
- Realist: substances, qualities and modes objectively real; aspects are in the object.

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08

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STAGE 08EVALUATING NON-ABSOLUTISM: THREE DISTINCT CHALLENGES

SELF-REFUTATION OR TRIVIALITY2022: RELATIVISM NEEDS ABSOLUTISM2025: PLURALIST AND REALIST?KEVALA-JÑĀNA IS THE PIVOTQUALIFIED REALISMRESIDUE MUST BE STATED

A — SELF-REFUTATION OR TRIVIALITY

- If qualified it looks weak; if unqualified it breaks its own rule.
- Jaina reply walks through the first horn: the thesis is itself asserted syāt.
- Aspect-conditioned truth is not equal truth for all opinions.
- Triviality is answered only by showing the work the doctrine does.

B — THE 2022 ABSOLUTISM CHARGE

- The charge equivocates between denying exclusivism and denying comprehensiveness.
- Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers.
- Omniscience is the internal complete case, since obscuring karma is destroyed.
- Residue: the unconditioned is relocated to omniscience, not abolished.

C — THE 2025 CLASSIFICATION

- Plural: six substances, innumerable souls, many perfected souls, no monistic reduction.
- Realist: substances, qualities and modes objectively real; aspects are in the object.
- Qualifier: judgement is standpoint-indexed, hence qualified realism.
- Key line: qualification of knowledge does not entail unreality of the object.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The three challenges dissect consistency, presupposition and classification respectively, so a single generic defence necessarily under-answers two of them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Non-absolutism survives self-refutation because it accepts that its own thesis is standpoint-qualified while denying that qualification means indeterminacy.

09

STAGE 09BONDAGE: THE CAUSES, THE TWO FORMS AND THE FOUR PARAMETERS

KARMA IS LITERALLY MATTERFIVE CAUSES OF BONDAGEBHĀVABANDHA AND DRAVYABANDHA

ACTIVITY FIXES TYPE AND QUANTITYPASSION FIXES DURATION AND INTENSITYĪRYĀPATHIKA VERSUS SĀMPARĀYIKANOT ADRṢṬA, APŪRVA OR VĀSANĀ

FIVE CAUSES, IN ORDER

- Wrong vision (mithyātva) misapprehends soul, reality and path.
- Non-restraint (avirati) leaves conduct exposed; carelessness (pramāda) weakens vigilance.
- Passions (kaṣāya) — anger, pride, deceit, greed — supply the adhesion.
- Activity (yoga) of body, speech and mind opens the channel of influx.

TWO FORMS THAT MUST NOT COLLAPSE

- Psychic bondage: the soul's own passionate modification (bhāva-karma).
- Material bondage: the actual adhesion of karmic particles (dravya-karma).
- Keep only the first and karma becomes a metaphor.
- Keep only the second and intention becomes irrelevant to moral consequence.

FOUR PARAMETERS AND THEIR OWNERS

- Type (prakṛti) and quantity (pradeśa) are fixed by ACTIVITY.
- Duration (sthiti) and intensity (anubhāga) are fixed by PASSION.
- Hence passion-free activity binds only momentarily; angry action binds deeply.
- Trap: never assign duration to activity or quantity to passion.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Inner disposition governs the severity of a real material bondage, which is why an identical bodily movement can be nearly inert in a disciplined agent and gravely binding in an angry one.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina originality lies in treating action and moral consequence not as a moral record but as subtle material bondage.

10

STAGE 10THE EIGHT KARMA-TYPES AND WHAT EACH ONE COSTS

FOUR DESTRUCTIVE (GHĀTIYĀ)FOUR NON-DESTRUCTIVE (AGHĀTIYĀ)MOHANIYĀ IS THE WORSTDESTROY GHĀTIYĀ, GAIN OMNISCIENCEAGHĀTIYĀ SUSTAIN EMBODIMENT

CLASS	KARMA-TYPE	WHAT IT OBSCURES OR DETERMINES	SIGNIFICANCE
Destructive	Jñānavarāṇiṃ	Knowledge	Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Destructive	Darśnavarāṇiṃ	Perception or apprehension	Blocks direct awareness
Destructive	Mohanīya	Right vision and right conduct	Worst: delusion misorients the whole path
Destructive	Antarāya	Energy and capacity to act	Obstructs the soul's effective power
Non-destructive	Vedanīya	Pleasure and pain	Shapes felt experience without destroying essence
Non-destructive	Nāma	Body and embodiment	Determines the type of body
Non-destructive	Gotra	Status conditions	Determines high or low standing
Non-destructive	Āyus	Lifespan	Determines duration of embodied life

WHY THE SPLIT MATTERS

- Destroying the destructive group yields omniscience at the thirteenth stage.
- The non-destructive group continues to sustain body, status and lifespan.
- This is what makes embodied omniscience intelligible rather than paradoxical.

CROSS-SCHOOL CONTRAST

- Nyāya adrṣṭa is an unseen quality of the self, not matter.
- Mīmāṃsā apūrva is a ritual potency; Sāṃkhya saṃskāra is a dispositional trace.
- Buddhist vāsanā is a mental impression with no material particle at all.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Deluding karma is divided into vision-deluding and conduct-deluding, so the taxonomy explains why wrong orientation corrupts both seeing and acting at once.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The karma taxonomy exists to explain why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure and lifespan are all karmically structured.

11

STAGE 11THE PATH AND THE FOURTEEN STAGES (GUṆASTHĀNA): STOP, SHED, ASCEND

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STAGE 11

THE PATH AND THE FOURTEEN STAGES (GUṆASTHĀNA): STOP, SHED, ASCEND

SAṂVARA STOPS, NIRJARĀ SHEDS

THREE JEWELS, JOINTLY

MAHĀVRATA AND AṆUVRATA

STAGE 4 IS THE BREAKTHROUGH

STAGE 11 NECESSARILY FALLS

SAYOGA-KEVALĪ = EMBODIED OMNISCIENCE

LIBERATION (MOKṢA) = SIDDHA, STILL AN INDIVIDUAL

STAGES 1-3: false, falling and mixed orientation

STAGE 4: right vision, no restraint — the breakthrough

STAGES 5-7: lay vows, then full restraint refined

STAGES 8-10: passions refined from gross to only subtle greed

STAGES 11-12: delusion suppressed, or destroyed

STAGES 13-14: embodied omniscience, then activity ceases and the soul is perfected

TWO OPERATIONS, TWO PROBLEMS

- Stoppage is preventive: vows, restraint (gupti), carefulness (samiti), ten virtues, contemplations, endurance of afflictions.
- Shedding is eliminative: austerity, repentance, humility, service, study, detachment, meditation.
- Sweeping a room whose door stands open is endless work.
- Merit is still bondage: it improves the rebirth, it does not release from rebirth.

THE TWO LADDERS

- Suppression covers delusion, reaches stage eleven, and necessarily falls back.
- Annihilation destroys delusion, reaches stage twelve, and continues.
- Suppression and destruction look identical outside and have opposite futures.
- This gives Jainism a principled account of spiritual relapse.

THE LIBERATED SOUL — THE 2018 DEMAND

- Individuality retained; numerically distinct; no merger into a universal consciousness.
- Infinite knowledge and perception fully manifest; disembodied and activity-free.
- No return: bondage is beginningless yet terminable; the soul rises to the summit of the world.
- Voluntary passionless death is gradual, supervised and public, and is not suicide.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Because bondage has two independent problems, arrival and accumulation, the path needs two independent remedies rather than a single moral improvement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Liberation is subtraction and not acquisition, so the perfected soul remains a numerically distinct individual rather than merging into any absolute.

12

STAGE 12

NAMED CRITICS, THE PYQ RAIL AND THE ANSWER SPINE

ŚAṂKARA · RĀMĀNUJA · DHARMAKĪRTI

NYĀYA · SĀṂKHYA-VEDĀNTA · CĀRVĀKA

ARTHAKRİYĀ DILEMMA

NINE OWNED PYQS, ONE ROUTED

REALISM WITHOUT DOGMATISM

OPEN: define the real, then say the logic follows from it

BODY: ontology to knowledge to standpoint to syāt to the seven predications

BODY: bondage to two forms to four parameters to stoppage, shedding and stages

TEST: one NAMED objection, its reply, and the residue stated honestly

CLOSE: qualified realism — ethically serious, logically subtle, metaphysically costly

SIX CRITICS, SIX JOINTS

- Śaṁkara attacks predication; reply is the four indices, residue is assertoric force.
- Rāmānuja attacks opposed real attributes; reply is substance and mode.
- Dharmakīrti attacks a permanent-yet-changing soul through causal efficacy.
- Nyāya attacks the soul's extension; Sāṁkhya-Vedānta attacks beginningless obscuration; Cārvāka attacks verifiability.

PYQ RAIL 2018-2025

- 2018 Q6(c) 15 bondage and the liberated soul; 2019 Q6(a) 20 reality and judgement.
- 2020 Q5(a) 10 karma and liberation; 2020 Q7(c) 15 Cārvāka and Jaina reality, routed.
- 2021 Q7(c) 15 sevenfold naya; 2022 Q5(d) 10 karma and soteriology; 2022 Q6(b) 15 relativism.
- 2023 Q5(a) 10 sevenfold judgement; 2024 Q6(c) 15 two bondages; 2025 Q7(c) 15 pluralist and realist.

READY VERDICTS BY MARK BAND

- 10 marks: a pluralistic realism avoiding both pure permanence and pure flux.
- 15 marks: many-sided reality joined to conditional judgement, with contestable karmic physics.
- 20 marks: a rigorous qualified realism, systematic and ethically powerful, yet vulnerable on interaction and verification.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each classical objection targets a distinct commitment, so each reply mobilises a distinct resource and a single generic defence under-answers most of them.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism, internally systematic and ethically powerful, yet vulnerable to external critique.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

LOGIC OR DISCIPLINED ASSERTION?

SPATIALITY OF THE SOUL

BESIDE MADHYMAKA

CONTROLLED WESTERN PARALLELS

INTERPRETIVE DISPUTES

- Is the sevenfold schema a proto-many-valued logic or context-indexed assertion?
- Classical reading: syāt is an index of respect, not a truth-value.
- Does the soul really contract and expand, or is extension a mode of embodiment?

COMPARATIVE ENRICHMENT

- Beside Madhyamaka: real substances persist through real modes, so this is realist pluralism.
- Western parallels are illustrative only; state the disanalogy in the same sentence.
- Perspectivism is often anti-realist, whereas Jaina aspects are in the object.

WHAT NOT TO OVER-STUDY

- Full sub-classification trees of the standpoints and cosmographic enumerations.
- Sectarian numerology and exhaustive sub-varieties of the eight karma-types.
- These consume the time an answer needs for its evaluative paragraph.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.